

1. Windows 1.0

What really puts 1985 in perspective-especially when it comes to how simple the times were, was the fact that using your computer to get in touch with your pen pal in Japan involved firing up all 4 megabytes of storage and 256 kB of ram, typing out your letter, printing it, finding an air mail envelope and making a trip to the post office.

This was also the year when Microsoft started spreading its influence.

Available at <http://jsmachines.net>, this version of Windows is clocked at a speed of 4.77 Mhz, with 256kB of RAM and a hard drive with 10MB of storage. While you can't really save stuff and use it to satiate your more hipser-y cravings, you can however, play in black and white with Paint, explore over two shades of grey on Notepad and Write and most importantly, play games like Reversi.

While Windows 1.0 really sucked and was only a front end to Microsoft's DOS and it didn't really do well, Microsoft picked themselves up and came back for more.

2. Windows 3.0

Five years later, available in 256 glorious colours was Windows 3.0, the product that would go on to help make Microsoft what it is today. With colour monitors more widely available, the Windows 3.0 operating system was introduced at a time when the world was beginning to open up. The year was 1990, East and West Germany reunite, Bon Jovi split up and



What started it all